

Philip Johnson

Remembered in his obituary as 'the elder statesman and enfant terrible of American architecture', Philip Johnson (1906–2005) spent his early years championing modernism and its exponents, particularly Mies van der Rohe and Gropius; he would later work with Mies, notably on the Seagram Building (1958). Another key influence on Johnson was Le Corbusier. In 1930, Johnson founded the Department of Architecture and Design at New York's Museum of Modern Art, where the 1932 exhibition he put on with Hitchcock introduced America to the international style. After graduating in architecture, he designed for his own use the Glass House (1949) in New Canaan; an archetype in the international style, its spare rectangle of glass and steel encloses an airily open interior. Johnson later explored other styles, and his partnership with John Burgee (b.1933) from 1967 to 1991 sired a string of postmodernist landmarks including the trapezoid towers of Pennzoil Place (1976) in Houston, the broken-pedimented AT&T building (1984) in New York, and the aptly nicknamed Lipstick Building (1986), also New York.



One PPG Place in Pittsburgh, Johnson, 1981–4